

Cybersecurity Basics for Students

- Understand why students are frequent targets for attackers
- Recognize that personal devices hold academic and financial data
- Adopt a proactive mindset to reduce risk

Common Cyber Threats

- Malware such as ransomware and spyware can steal or lock data
- Social engineering exploits trust to gain credentials
- Unpatched software creates vulnerabilities attackers exploit

Phishing Attacks

- Emails or messages mimic legitimate sources to steal login info
- Check sender addresses, hover over links, and verify requests independently
- Report suspicious messages to campus IT immediately

Creating Strong Passwords

- Use at least 12 characters with mixed case, numbers, and symbols
- Avoid dictionary words, personal info, and reused passwords
- Store passwords in a reputable password manager

Multi-Factor Authentication

- MFA adds a second verification step beyond passwords
- Prefer authenticator apps or hardware tokens over SMS codes
- Enable MFA on email, learning platforms, and financial accounts

Safe Public Wi-Fi Use

- Avoid accessing sensitive accounts on open networks
- Use a trusted VPN to encrypt traffic on campus or coffee shop Wi-Fi
- Disable auto-connect and forget networks after use

Protecting Your Data Privacy

- Limit personal information shared on social media and university portals
- Review app permissions and revoke unnecessary access
- Encrypt devices and back up data regularly

Daily Security Habits & Key Takeaways

- Lock screens and log out when stepping away from devices
- Keep operating systems, apps, and antivirus updated automatically
- Stay informed about new threats through campus security alerts